

Envelope 1 (print once the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union)

https://www.europarl.europa.eu/charter/pdf/text_en.pdf

Envelope 2 (print three times)

Narrator:

Title of the piece: "One Drop Too Many"

Setting: A meeting room in the Council of the European Union building in Brussels.

Time: Late evening, after a meeting. A Danish Minister and a Swedish Minister are sitting at a round table, files spread out. Rain is pattering against the windows.

Swedish minister:

It's quite remarkable – rainwater, of all things, is now to be taxed. An EU-wide levy. Soon, even the sky won't escape Brussels' jurisdiction.

Danish Minister

We'll see! The proposal is definitely on the table.

Swedish minister:

Only Italy is objecting.

Danish Minister

Yes. Rome sees it as too deep an infringement on national tax sovereignty. The crucial question now is: Can they actually prevent the proposal in the Council?

Swedish minister (flipping through the documents):

If the measure only concerned an environmental issue, probably not. Then, as in many other areas, a qualified majority would suffice.

Danish Minister

That's right! But an EU-wide rainwater tax is clearly a fiscal measure. And the Treaty on the Functioning of the European Union makes a clear exception here: EU-wide tax measures must be adopted unanimously.

Narrator:

Short pause. They both look at each other.

Swedish minister:

So the answer is: Yes. Italy can block the proposal!

Dänische Ministerin (nachdenklich):

Rain as a source of revenue. What an interesting idea!

Swedish minister:

Well, in the European Union, many things fall from the sky – but without a legal basis, they don't stay there for long!

Narrator:

They both laugh softly. The lights dim, the rain grows louder.

Horror at the Moselle: Dispute over wastewater escalates

Metz/Trier — A serious incident in France is causing tensions in the border region: Environment Minister Agnès Pannier-Runacher has announced that she is considering a change in the law that would allow a factory near the border to discharge toxic wastewater into the Moselle.

On the German side—particularly in Trier—the plan has sparked outrage. Residents are worried about severe harm to the environment, drinking water, and tourism. Citizen groups have announced protests and called for legal action. **“The Moselle is our lifeline—we will defend it,”** said a spokesperson.

Whether the plan will go ahead remains unclear. However, pressure from the border region is increasing daily.



France's Environment Minister wants to legally permit a factory near the border to discharge toxic wastewater into the Moselle River. Should France be allowed to make this decision at the national level?

Discuss!

Article 222/Treaty on the Functioning of the European Union

1. The Union and its Member States shall act jointly in a spirit of solidarity if a Member State is the object of a terrorist attack or the victim of a natural or man-made disaster. The Union shall mobilise all the instruments at its disposal, including the military resources made available by the Member States, to:

- prevent the terrorist threat in the territory of the Member States;
- protect democratic institutions and the civilian population from any terrorist attack;
- assist a Member State in its territory, at the request of its political authorities, in the event of a terrorist attack;

2. Should a Member State be the object of a terrorist attack or the victim of a natural or man-made disaster, the other Member States shall assist it at the request of its political authorities. To that end, the Member States shall coordinate between themselves in the Council.

3. The arrangements for the implementation by the Union of the solidarity clause shall be defined by a decision adopted by the Council acting on a joint proposal by the Commission and the High Representative of the Union for Foreign Affairs and Security Policy. The Council shall act in accordance with Article 31(1) of the Treaty on European Union where this decision has defence implications. The European Parliament shall be informed.

For the purposes of this paragraph and without prejudice to Article 240, the Council shall be assisted by the Political and Security Committee with the support of the structures developed in the context of the common security and defence policy and by the Committee referred to in Article 71; the two committees shall, if necessary, submit joint opinions.

4. The European Council shall regularly assess the threats facing the Union in order to enable the Union and its Member States to take effective action.

https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A12016E222&utm_source=chatgpt.com

Envelope 5.1. (print once)



105 likes, 1 share, 1 comment

grape_festival Pozývame vás do Trenčína na otvárací ceremoniál Európskeho hlavného mesta kultúry 2026 ... mehr

14. Februar · Übersetzung anzeigen

Envelope 5.2. (print once)



Envelope 6.1. (Print once, cut out the dots)

Put the steps of a European Citizens' Initiative in the correct order:

- Wait a maximum of two months until the EU hopefully approves the application 😊.
- Clarify whether the EU has jurisdiction over the issue.
- Receive a response from the Commission (within a maximum of 6 months). The Commission must explain what follow-up measures it will take, if any, and justify why it is taking action or ruling out further action. Ideally, this will result in legislation or other suitable implementation measures.
- Submit the application to have the initiative approved.
- Form an organizing group with at least 7 EU citizens from 7 EU countries.
- Submit the signatures to the authorities in the respective countries for verification and hopefully receive the go-ahead within 3 months.
- Collect at least 1 million signatures from EU citizens in at least 7 EU countries.
- Submit the initiative to the Commission!!!

Envelope 6.2.: Solution (print once, place face down in the envelope)

1. Determine whether the EU has **jurisdiction** over this issue.
2. Form an **organizing group** with at least 7 EU citizens from 7 EU countries.
3. Submit an application to have **the initiative approved**.
4. Wait a maximum of two months until the EU hopefully approves the application 😊.
5. **Collect** at least 1 million **signatures** from EU citizens in at least 7 EU countries.
6. Submit the **signatures** to the authorities in the respective countries for **verification** and hopefully receive approval within 3 months.
7. **Submit the initiative** to the Commission!!!
8. **Receive a response** from the Commission (within 6 months at the latest). The Commission must explain what follow-up measures it will take, if any, and justify why it is taking action or ruling out further measures. Ideally, this will lead to legislation or other suitable measures for implementation.

Envelope 7.1. (print once)

Check which of these tasks, which led to the arrest of the criminal group, was undertaken by Europol?

- ☐ Monitoring of transport movements
- ☐ Cross-referencing of supply chains
- ☐ Establishment of a joint investigation team
- ☐ Analysis of cryptocurrency payments
- ☐ Evaluation of encrypted chat groups
- ☐ Analysis of server locations
- ☐ Arrest of suspects in multiple countries
- ☐ Search of warehouses
- ☐ Seizure of the bars in the supermarkets

Envelope 7.2. (print once on transparency film)



„Bonus-envelope“ (print once)

Discuss in your group:

In your opinion, should the EU be given more powers or should powers be returned to the nation states?